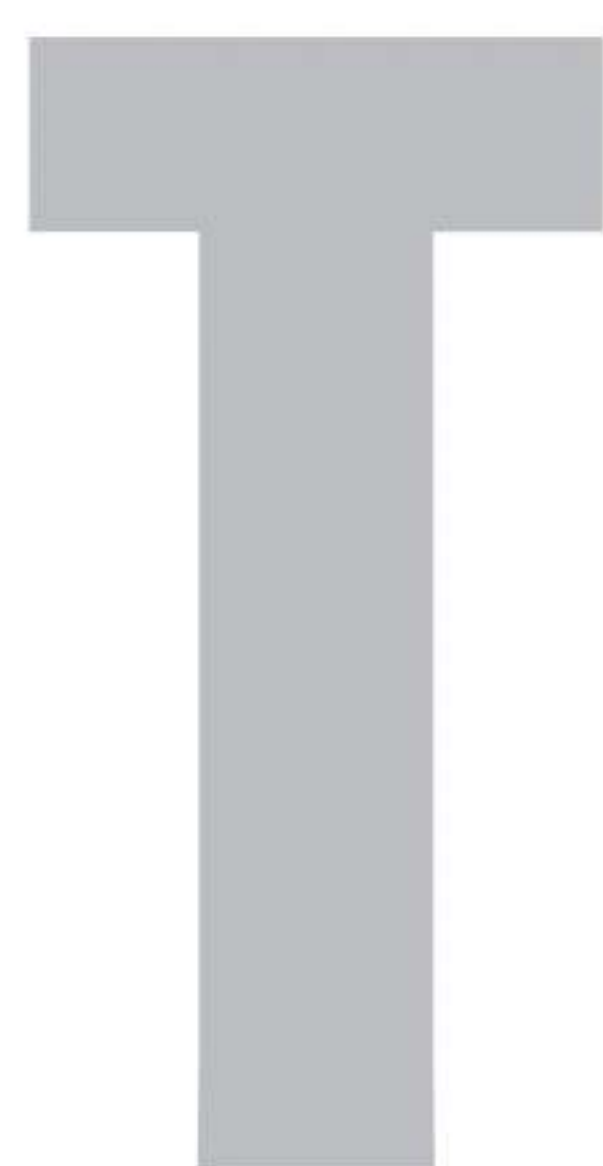


Duplantis soars, Neeraj shines: Athletics powerhouses stand out again

Armand Duplantis dominated 2024 athletics, [breaking pole vault records](#) while Neeraj Chopra continued to be India's flagbearer with an Olympic silver.

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he defining image of athletics in 2024 must surely be Armand Duplantis repeatedly breaking his pole vault world record.

The Swedish athlete dominated the spotlight in an Olympic year that saw a series of world records shattered.

Duplantis' first record-breaking vault came in April at the Xiamen Diamond League meet, where he cleared 6.24 meters.

At the Paris Olympics, he clinched the gold with an Olympic-record leap of 6.10m, celebrating with a pose inspired by Yusuf Dikec, the Turkish shooter known for his nonchalant stance earlier in the Games.

Duplantis then raised the stakes, improving his world record by a centimetre, to 6.25m, in front of an ecstatic Parisian crowd.

With his victories in Paris, the 25-year-old became the second man to win two Olympic gold medals in pole vault, following in the footsteps of America's Bob Richards (1952 and 1956).

But Duplantis wasn't finished. Just 20 days after his

Paris triumph, he set a new world record of 6.26m at the Silesia Diamond League meeting.

Duplantis' 2024 achievements weren't confined to the pole vault mat. In an exhibition race in Zurich in September, he outpaced 400m hurdler Karsten Warholm over 100 meters, clocking a personal best time of 10.37 seconds.

Paris showdown

The athletics showdown at the Paris Olympics, held at the Stade de France, lived up to expectations as records tumbled amidst high-quality action.

In the men's 100m race, the USA's Noah Lyles claimed gold in a thrilling photo finish, edging out Jamaica's Kishane Thompson by just five-thousandths of a second.

Saint Lucia secured its first-ever Olympic medal through Julian Alfred,